

Niklas Hlubek

Epidemiologist & Health Data Scientist

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Nationality: German

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Dutch (fluent)



Epidemiologist with 4+ years of experience generating evidence from large-scale real-world health data, from study design to analysis code. Combines causal inference expertise with software development in R to build reproducible, scalable analyses – currently in multi-database studies on medicines and vaccines that inform European regulatory decisions.

Professional Experience

Epidemiologist & Statistical Programmer | Real-World Evidence Group, UMC Utrecht | 2026 – present

- Conduct **pharmacoepidemiological studies on medicines and vaccines** using real-world data from healthcare databases across Europe.
- Develop **R software for quality checking and analysis** of distributed real-world data from European data partners.
- Apply **causal inference study designs, including target trial emulation**, in European and global studies that directly inform regulatory decision-making.

Doctoral Researcher (Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellow) | UMC Utrecht, Netherlands | 2023 – 2025

- Linked **nationwide health registry, sociodemographic and environmental data on >12 million people** (>70M observations) within the secure remote-access environment of Statistics Netherlands.
- Built **memory-efficient, reproducible R pipelines** and reusable linkage and preprocessing functions for computationally intensive analyses.
- Applied **survival analysis with time-varying exposures, multilevel models and causal inference methods** to study socioeconomic inequalities in stroke, mortality and environmental risk factors.
- Communicated results to clinical, academic and policy audiences, including contributions to an EU Commission strategic report; 5 first-author publications.

Visiting Researcher | ISGlobal – Barcelona Institute for Global Health, Spain | 2024

- Designed a **natural experiment (difference-in-differences with propensity score matching)**, harmonising data from two large European birth cohorts in shared Git repositories with code review.

Research Consultant | Municipality of Utrecht, Netherlands | 2024

- Built an interactive **R Shiny** monitoring dashboard on environmental health risks and advised municipal decision-makers.

Policy & Project Assistant | Mental Health Europe, Brussels, Belgium | 2022

- Coordinated European mental health initiatives and wrote evidence-based policy briefs for EU-level decision-makers.

Technical Skills

Methods & Study Design

- Causal inference:** target trial emulation, propensity scores & inverse probability weighting, difference-in-differences
- Time-to-event & longitudinal analysis:** Cox models with time-varying covariates, multilevel models
- Real-world data:** registry linkage, multi-database studies, data quality assessment

Programming & Data

- R (advanced):** *tidyverse*, *data.table*, *survival*, *WeightIt*, *lme4*, *sf*, *shiny*; reusable function development
- Also:** SQL, Python; Git/GitHub with code review; Quarto/R Markdown for reproducible reporting
- Secure environments:** GDPR-compliant remote-access and federated research environments

Education

PhD	Epidemiology Utrecht University, Netherlands - 2026
MSc	Social Policy & Public Health Utrecht University, Netherlands - 2022
MSc	Psychological Research University of Edinburgh, UK - 2021
BSc	Psychology Erasmus University Rotterdam, Netherlands - 2019